

Track 2 · Civic Participation and Leadership

Diwan Hackathon 2026 · *Redefine the role of equations: not merely following rules, but shaping them.*

The problem. Tens of millions of Muslims live across the EU and UK appear in policy in the context of counter-extremism programmes, prayer-room and hijab cases, mosque-funding restrictions, deportation regimes, anti-protest powers. The means to follow and act on those decisions are public and open to anyone through parliamentary votes, court rulings, procurement records, freedom of information and equality bodies. They are, however, scattered across national systems and rarely available in the languages much of the community reads, so the people governed the most are equipped to follow along the least. The will to engage is there; but we miss the software to act on it. This challenge asks you to close that gap.

*You can work on one of two sub-challenges. **Daylight** is for making the decisions of public institutions easy to follow and make sense of for the people they affect. **Leverage** is for helping those people respond, so that what they want has weight where decisions are made. Work on real public data, and build something to empower people after the weekend!*

A. Daylight

Public institutions decide things every day that shape how people live their faith, move, organise, and are policed. Those decisions are on a public record that is spread across many national systems, written for specialists, and inaccessible. Following them takes time, training, and a fluency that many of the affected people lack. This track aims to close that distance by transforming what the institutions publish and decide. The goal is make it easier for an ordinary person to find, follow, and genuinely understand.

A strong Daylight project makes public decision-making more visible and more understandable to the people it affects. The main question you should ask when developing a solution: does someone who is not a specialist come away knowing more about what their institutions are doing and what it means for them?

QUESTIONS TO DEEPEN THE CHALLENGE

- *Who is the person you picture using this, and what do they want to know that they cannot find now?*
- *Where does the information already live, and what makes it hard to reach or hard to read right now?*
- *What does “understandable” mean for your audience: their language, the questions they actually ask, the moment they need an answer, the creative way you represent the info?*
- *How do you keep what you show accurate and current as the underlying source changes?*
- *Is the information valuable for the person to act upon and what does it enable them to do?*

B. Leverage

Knowing what is happening is not enough. Public systems also give people ways to respond: to ask for information they are owed, to challenge a decision, to put a question to the people who represent them, to see where public and pension money goes and take action. There are routes that exist and are open to anyone, but using them well means knowing which door to knock on, what to say, and when. Leverage is about using open data and action space and making initiating actions easier and more accessible. The aim is to connect people to real and legitimate ways that public institutions can be asked, answered, or held to account.

A strong Leverage project moves a person or a group from wanting to respond to being able to, and gives that response weight where decisions are made. The main question for this track is whether it carries someone all the way to a real action through a route that has a tangible impact.

QUESTIONS TO DEEPEN THE CHALLENGE

- *What does the person want to change or obtain, and what stands between them and doing it today?*
- *Which real route applies, and what does it demand?*
- *After the action is taken, how does the person know it was effective, and what happens if their action isn't acted upon?*
- *How could a group acting together carry more weight than one person acting alone?*

RESOURCES

Below are example resources that can be used for the civic participation and leadership challenge. Note that Diwan has no affiliation with any of them and takes no responsibility in their usage. You may make use of any other resources you find.

EU level

- [EU Parliament Open Data Portal](#): MEPs, plenary activity, votes, and legislative documents over a free REST API, no key.
- [HowTheyVote.eu](#): per-MEP roll-call vote positions as a stable [bulk CSV](#).
- [Parltrack](#): bulk dumps of MEPs, dossiers, votes, and amendments in one place, no key.
- [EUR-Lex via CELLAR SPARQL](#): EU legislation and Court of Justice case law. The [cellar-extractor](#) Python library makes the endpoint approachable in a weekend.
- [TED \(Tenders Electronic Daily\) v3](#): EU public procurement notices, free to search without a key.
- [Eurostat](#): official European statistics over a free JSON API, no key.
- [EU Transparency Register](#): registered lobbyists and their declared spending, as a daily bulk download.

National parliaments

- [UK Parliament](#): members, bills, votes, written questions, and Hansard.
- [Finland. Eduskunta](#): the host country's open parliamentary data, including per-member votes.
- [Sweden. Riksdag](#): documents, motions, and member data in JSON.
- [Denmark. Folketinget](#): full legislative process data over an OData API.
- [Germany. abgeordnetenwatch](#): MP profiles, votes, and a public question-and-answer record.

Rights and platform data

- [DSA Transparency Database](#): content-moderation decisions from major platforms operating in the EU, over a REST API and bulk download.
- [HUDOC](#): European Court of Human Rights judgments and decisions, including the religious-practice case law.
- Freedom-of-information corpora you can read and surface: [FragDenStaat](#) (Germany, open REST API), [WhatDoTheyKnow](#) (UK, append .json to any request), and [AskTheEU](#) (EU bodies).
- [EU Fundamental Rights Agency](#): the [Being Muslim in the EU 2024](#) findings and the [Anti-Muslim Hatred Database](#) as an evidence base.

Freedom of information

- [Froide / FragDenStaat](#): the open Python engine behind Germany's FOI platform, with a documented REST API. The most build-friendly starting point.
- [Alaveteli](#): the platform behind [WhatDoTheyKnow](#) and [AskTheEU](#), with readable JSON on any running instance.

Reach decision-makers

- [abgeordnetenwatch](#): German MP profiles and the public questions citizens put to them.
- [UK Parliament Members API](#): contact details and voting context for every member.
- [Decidim](#): an open participatory-democracy platform with a read GraphQL API on live public instances, including Helsinki and Barcelona.

Follow the money (a screening pipeline you can stand up in a weekend)

- [OpenSanctions](#): sanctions, politically exposed persons, watchlists, and the OHCHR settlements list as one clean, deduplicated dataset. Free for non-commercial use, with a full bulk download.
- [EU Financial Sanctions List](#): the authoritative EU list, [publicly downloadable](#).
- [OpenFIGI](#): map an ISIN or ticker to the issuer behind it. Free API key, granted instantly.
- [GLEIF](#): resolve a company to its legal identity and parent, over an open API and bulk download.

- UN OHCHR database of businesses in Israeli settlements: use the structured [OpenSanctions mirror](#) rather than the source PDF.
- [SIPRI Top 100](#): the largest arms companies by revenue, as a downloadable spreadsheet.

Reach people directly

- [Telegram Bot API](#): free and set up in minutes, good for organised community groups.
- [WhatsApp Business Cloud API](#): a free test sandbox, and the widest reach into many diaspora communities.
- [Twilio SMS](#): free trial credit, reaches anyone with a phone.